4.7 Cardiomyopathy*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I feel tired all the time and get breathless." **Objective** • Reduced ejection fraction on echocardiography • S3 gallop • Edema	**ACTUAL** Excessive fluid volume related to impaired myocardial contractility as evidenced by edema, an S3 gallop and dyspnea.	• Edema and breathlessness lessen, with vital signs stable.	• Follow vital signs, daily weight and edema. • Give heart failure medicines as prescribed. • Restrict sodium as ordered. • Watch the ECG for dysrhythmias.	• Goal reached when symptoms ease.
Subjective • "I cannot work as before." **Objective** • Breathless on exertion • HR rises by 25/min with activity	**ACTUAL** Decreased activity tolerance related to reduced cardiac reserve as evidenced by exertional dyspnea.	• Within 1 week, plans daily activity within his limits, with less breathlessness.	• Teach energy conservation: sit for tasks, rest between them. • Advise against heavy lifting and strenuous exercise, as the cardiologist directs. • Check HR, BP and SpO_2 during activity. • Refer to cardiac rehabilitation.	• Met when he follows the activity plan.
Subjective • Reports palpitations **Objective** • Dilated heart chambers	**RISK** Risk for decreased cardiac output as evidenced by risk factors: dysrhythmias and thromboembolism associated with dilated chambers.	• No serious dysrhythmia or embolic event.	• Keep the rhythm under observation. • Give anticoagulation as prescribed. • Teach the warning signs of stroke.	• Achieved if no such event occurs.

* **References for this care plan:** [17], [32], [33], [35]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.